

Canadian Grand Prix – Fastest lap comparison; Russell vs Norris:

Qualifying at the 2026 Canadian Grand Prix seen Russell claim his fourth pole position, closely followed by his teammate and 2025 World Champion Lando Norris.

Below is an overlay of the publicly available telemetry data for both cars, and a follow-up brief discussion on the differences between the two laps:

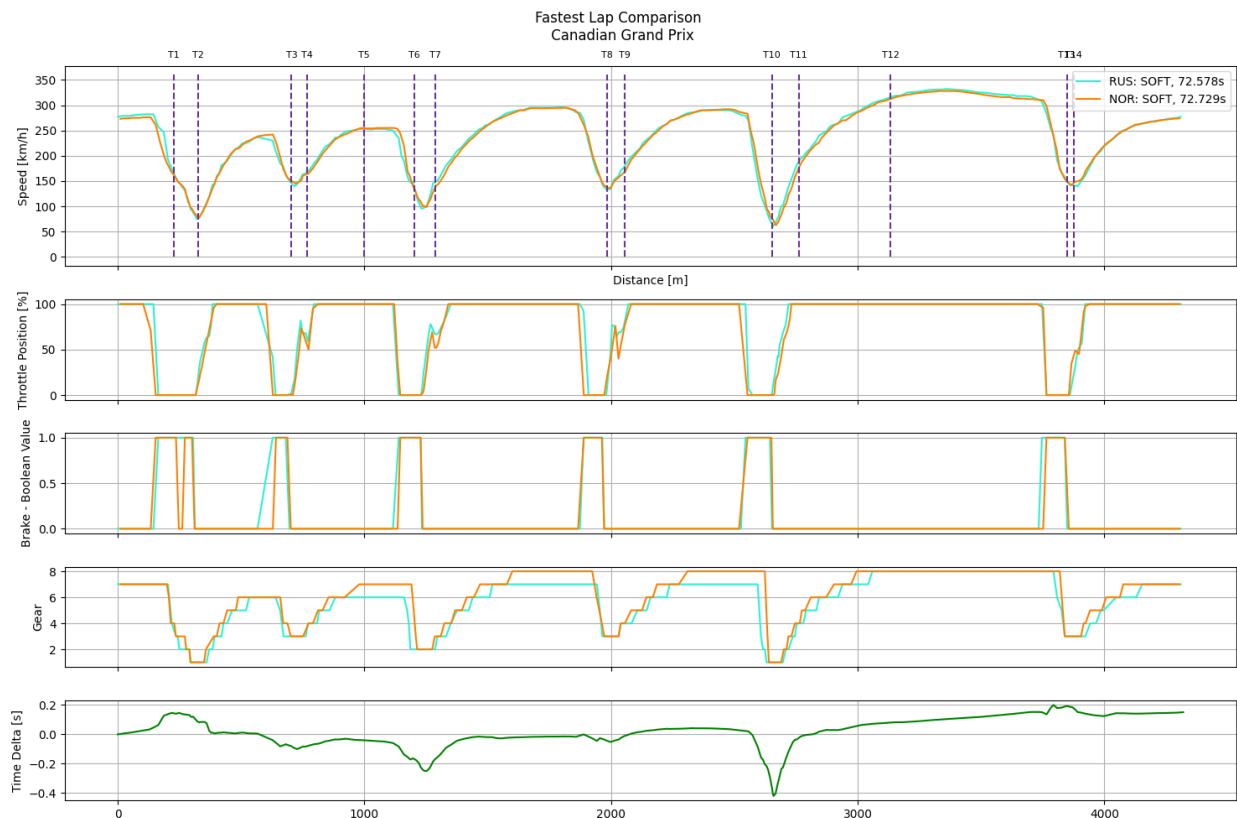


Figure 1: RUS vs NOR fastest lap comparison

There are a few interesting things to discuss after reviewing the telemetry we have:

- Russell gains early T1 advantage by lifting ~45m later (~0.16s) but loses all the advantage from T2 to T6. Norris begins to gain an advantage over Russell in T3, where he brakes ~60m later and has a similar throttle application to Russell on exit gaining ~0.1s, and in T6, where he brakes ~20m later with a slightly lighter, later throttle application than Russell, gaining an additional ~0.17s, but losing that additional gain on exit.
- Russell brakes ~5 meters later than Norris into T10 and gains significantly with applying throttle ~15m earlier than Norris, gaining back ~0.45s, including the time lost to Norris under braking on the run to T12.
- From T12 to T13, Russell has higher top speed, the only place he enters 8th gear; Russell gains on Norris through the final chicane by braking ~20m earlier and a smoother, more confident throttle application on the exit of T14, culminating in a net gain of ~0.15s - Mercedes likely running slightly higher downforce for rear stability.

An important note is that downforce values are not publicly available, and are rather inferred from both the speed trace, throttle trace, and the brake trace. T8 and T9 were not ignored, rather no significant differences could be inferred from the available data.